

Monuments of Fleet Street

No. 124

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

There is a statue of Queen Elizabeth I from 1586. It is the oldest public statue in London. It was moved here after Ludgate was taken down in 1760.

Above the statue are Gog and Magog. They are legendary figures who strike the bells every hour.

At street level there is a carved head of Lord Northcliffe, a newspaper owner who supported the church.



The dragon marks the western boundary of the City of London at the site of the old Temple Bar. It stands in the middle of Fleet Street where it meets the Strand.

The monument was made in 1880 by Sir Charles Bell Birch. It also has a statue of Queen Victoria and plaques on its base.



This statue of Queen Elizabeth I was first on Ludgate, rebuilt during her reign. It has the date 1586 on its base, but it is hard to read. Ludgate was demolished in 1760 and the statue was moved here. It is believed to be the oldest public statue in London.



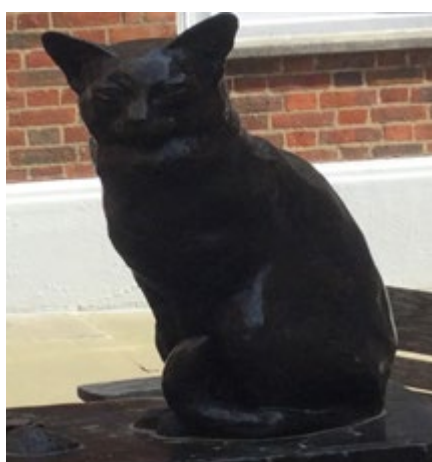
This statue of John Wilkes is on a pedestrian island where Fetter Lane and New Fetter Lane meet.

The inscription says:

“A champion of English Freedom. John Wilkes 1727–1797. Member of Parliament. Lord Mayor.”

When you visit the statue, you can listen to Jeremy Paxman reading from Wilkes’ writings.

John Wilkes was a complex and controversial man. He was a radical and strongly supported changes to Parliament.



Hodge was Doctor Johnson’s cat. His statue is in Gough Square outside Dr. Johnson’s house. This is a talking statue.

